



Civic Meeting Report

Parks Department Meeting October 15th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7MtOjHKjHIM
Publication Date	2024-10-16T12:20:22Z
Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Parks and Recreation Board

Date: Tuesday, October 15, 2024

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Brad Marshall called the Muncie Parks and Recreation Board meeting to order at [00:00:31](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chandra Park, James Lon, Mark Irvin, Shannon Powers, and Brad Marshall.
 - **Absent:** Carl (noted as absent at roll call [00:01:00](#)).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:41](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the previous meeting were approved by voice vote [00:01:23](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:15:13 Prairie Creek Rules and Regulations Revisions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Marshall, Board President, along with staff input.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed proposed draft updates to the Prairie Creek rules (dated October 9). Discussion centered on two specific items: defining minimum lease site dimensions to clear up neighbor disputes, and limiting boat dock leases to one per individual to mirror camper lease rules and open space for new interests. Legal counsel has not yet reviewed this latest draft.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:24:36** Mike Foster spoke in favor of mirroring the dock limit to one per individual.
 - **00:26:21** Rod Wage raised concerns about rule enforcement, unmonitored golf carts/four-wheelers driven by minors, abandoned trailers, and wake damage/erosion caused by large speedboats and wake boats on the reservoir.
 - **00:41:56** Joe Kar (Sail Club Commodore) discussed shoreline and dock anchor chain wear caused by wave action from wake and bass boats.
 - **00:46:16** Mike Foster spoke again regarding the underutilization and maintenance issues of park security gates.
 - **00:50:37** Dorothea Meadows expressed concern that the 25x30 minimum campsite rule is too small for many modern campers and canopies.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** No final vote taken; the board agreed to strike the fee/lease term sentence from the campsite rule (Section 9, Item H), adjust dock rules to one per individual, send the updated draft to legal, and target a future review/approval cycle.
- **01:01:16 Prairie Creek Rate Increases & Financial Planning**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Marshall / Board Members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The board discussed a proposed 5-year rate forecast for campsites and boat slips designed to prevent large, sudden rate hikes. Board members expressed hesitation to raise rates without a long-term strategic plan, visible improvements, or better security, noting that campers and boaters already fund the majority of Prairie Creek's revenue.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **01:12:25** Rod Wage stated that campers did not see the promised security or improvements following the last rate hike.
 - **01:16:34** Mike Foster criticized the budget's reliance on camper/boater fees and highlighted utility and power management issues.
 - **01:21:26** An unnamed resident (identifying as a camper/boater) argued against rate hikes, citing inadequate campsite sizing, lack of winter storage security, and poor electrical grid infrastructure.

- **01:26:28** Charlie Moore discussed the need for children's activities, trail maintenance, and reliable electrical service.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** The board agreed to table general rate increases for the upcoming year and focus instead on developing a comprehensive 5-year strategic plan for Prairie Creek.
 - **01:41:01 Boater Education Launch Fee Adjustment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Brad Marshall.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff noted that an intended adjustment to the boater education launch fee was overlooked the previous year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Passed Unanimously** by voice vote to increase the boater education launch fee to \$100 **01:41:35**.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:43:23 Caleb Schwartz (Ball State University Student Planning Association):**
 - Proposed installing a dedicated legal graffiti wall utilizing donated lockers from maker space at the Westside Skate Park to curb unsanctioned graffiti and foster community art.
 - Requested permission to post yard signs with QR codes for a community survey at Westside Park.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote 01:55:17** to conceptually approve the project, offer a board referral letter, and approve the posting of community survey yard signs at Westside Park.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **01:41:51** Shannon Powers announced upcoming grant notification dates: the 21st Century Learning Community Grant on October 21st, and the IU Health Community Impact Grant on November 1st.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote at the call of the presiding officer **01:56:37**.
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